

4. Add your seasonings

While the liquid is boiling, you can begin packing the jar as full of sliced cucumbers as you can fit (with room at the top). Then add your seasonings, which include $\frac{1}{4}$ cup chopped fresh dill (you can use less, if desired), $\frac{1}{4}$ tsp mustard seed, $\frac{1}{2}$ tsp black pepper (whole peppercorns work well), and finely chopped garlic cloves (five or more, depending on how strong you want them). I also add a teaspoon of red pepper flakes and will occasionally throw in a small jalapeño pepper for extra kick!

5. Fill and seal

Now that your brine has cooled, pour it over the cucumbers until the jar is full. Screw on your lid (if you're using a recycled spaghetti sauce jar) or your canning lid and ring (no need to pressure seal). Now just stick these guys in the fridge for a minimum of five days for awesome pickle flavor! They'll keep in the fridge for weeks (although they are usually gone within days). — **Linsey Knerl**



9 Ways to Save Big on Meat

Looking to make the most of your money-saving opportunities while cooking for the meat and potato lovers in your family? Find the cost of your favorite cuts is putting a rather large dent in your child's college fund? Read on. Help has arrived. Here's a list of ideas for meat money management.

1. Crumble away

This one mainly applies to ground meats, and the simplest way to go is with the one-pound frozen bullets. These provide additional flexibility, they don't freezer-burn as quickly, and their smaller size makes it easier to skip the breaking down required for other bulk purchases. Bonus? Aside from hamburger, they are usually what goes on sale anyway.

Thaw enough meat for a particular meal-prep session, and repackage any extra for another menu. (A good example of this would be scoring a handful or two of ground beef from the taco pan before adding seasonings